

Ancient History

- Indus Valley Civilization: Known for advanced urban planning, drainage systems, and cities like Harappa and Mohenjo-Daro.
- Vedic Period: Characterized by early Hindu texts (Vedas), rituals, pastoral economy, and development of kingdoms.
- Mauryan Empire: Founded by Chandragupta Maurya, expanded under Ashoka, famous for administration, Buddhism promotion, and Ashoka's edicts.

Medieval History

- Delhi Sultanate: Comprised dynasties such as Slave, Khilji, Tughlaq, Sayyid, and Lodi; introduced Persian culture and centralized administration.
- Mughal Empire: Established by Babur, flourished under Akbar with religious tolerance and administrative reforms; Shah Jahan built Taj Mahal; declined under Aurangzeb due to wars and weak successors.

Modern History

- British East India Company: Gained control after Battle of Plassey (1757), expanded territorial and economic dominance.
- Revolt of 1857: Sparked by sepoy grievances, symbolized first war of independence though suppressed by British.
- Social Reform Movements: Led by Raja Ram Mohan Roy (Brahmo Samaj), Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar (widow remarriage), and Swami Vivekananda (spiritual reform).

Contemporary History

- Indian National Congress: Formed in 1885, initially moderate but later led mass movements under leaders like Gandhi, Nehru, Patel, and Bose.
- Gandhi's Movements: Non-Cooperation (1920), Civil Disobedience (1930), and Quit India (1942) against British rule.
- Independence & Partition (1947): India gained independence but was partitioned into India and Pakistan, leading to massive migration and violence.
- Post-Independence India: Adoption of the Constitution (1950), establishment of democratic institutions, Green Revolution, and economic liberalization in 1991.